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JTI FRIDAY SERIES

SOUTHBANK CENTRE'S ROYAL FESTIVAL HALL
Friday 30 October 2009 | 7.30 pm

ALEXANDER VEDERNIKOV
conductor

PIERS LANE
piano

PROKOFIEV
Classical Symphony (13')

RACHMANINOFF
Concerto 2 in C minor for piano and orchestra (32')

INTERVAL

TCHAIKOVSKY
Symphony 4 in F minor (44')

PROGRAMME £3

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The timings shown are not precise and are given only as a guide.

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* *Holds a professorial appointment in London*

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LONDON PHILHARMONIC ORCHESTRA

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Seventy-seven years after Sir Thomas Beecham founded the London Philharmonic Orchestra, it is recognised today as one of the finest orchestras on the international stage. Following Beecham's influential founding tenure the Orchestra's Principal Conductorship has been passed from one illustrious musician to another, amongst them Sir Adrian Boult, Bernard Haitink, Sir Georg Solti, Klaus Tennstedt and Kurt Masur. This impressive tradition continued in September 2007 when Vladimir Jurowski became the Orchestra's Principal Conductor, and in a further exciting move, the Orchestra appointed Yannick Nézet-Séguin, its new Principal Guest Conductor from September 2008.

The London Philharmonic Orchestra has been performing at Southbank Centre's Royal Festival Hall since it opened in 1951, becoming Resident Orchestra in 1992. It plays there around 40 times each season with many of the world's most sought after conductors and soloists. Concert highlights in 2009/10 include *Between Two Worlds* – an exploration of the music and times of Alfred Schnittke; a Sibelius symphony cycle with Osmo Vänskä in January/February 2010; a performance of Mendelssohn's *Elijah* conducted by Kurt Masur and dedicated to the 20th Anniversary of the Fall of the Berlin Wall; and new works by Rautavaara, Górecki, Philip Glass, Ravi Shankar and the Orchestra's Composer in Residence, Mark-Anthony Turnage. Imaginative programming and a commitment to new music are at the heart of the Orchestra's activity, with regular commissions and world première performances.

In addition to its London season, the Orchestra has flourishing residencies in Brighton and Eastbourne, and performs regularly around the UK. It is unique in combining these concert activities with esteemed opera performances each summer at Glyndebourne Festival Opera where it has been the Resident Symphony Orchestra since 1964.

The London Philharmonic Orchestra performs to enthusiastic audiences all round the world. In 1956 it became the first British orchestra to appear in Soviet Russia and in 1973 made the first ever visit to China by a Western orchestra. Touring continues to form a significant part of the Orchestra's schedule, with regular appearances in North America, Europe and the Far East,

'The LPO rose to the occasion with some very fine playing: eloquent solo work combined with full-textured passages of often sumptuous beauty.'

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often headlining at major festivals. Tours in 2009/10 include visits to Germany, Australia, France, China, the Canaries and the USA.

Having long been embraced by the recording, broadcasting and film industries, the London Philharmonic Orchestra broadcasts regularly on domestic and international television and radio. It also works extensively with the Hollywood and UK film industries, recording soundtracks for blockbuster motion pictures including the Oscar-winning score for *The Lord of the Rings* trilogy and scores for *Lawrence of Arabia, The Mission, Philadelphia* and *East is East*.

The Orchestra also enjoys strong relationships with the major record labels and in 2005 began reaching out to new global audiences through the release of live, studio and archive recordings on its own CD label. Recent additions to the catalogue have included acclaimed releases of Shostakovich's monumental Tenth Symphony under Bernard Haitink; a disc of contemporary works by composers Thomas Adès, James MacMillan and Jennifer Higdon conducted by Marin Alsop; Rachmaninov's Symphony 3 along with Bax's *Tintagel* conducted by Osmo Vänskä; a CD of early Britten works conducted by Vladimir Jurowski; and Mahler's Symphony 6 under the baton of Klaus Tennstedt. The Orchestra's own-label releases are available to download by work or individual track from its website: www.lpo.org.uk/shop.

The Orchestra reaches thousands of Londoners through its rich programme of community and school-based activity in Lambeth, Lewisham and Southwark, which includes the offshoot ensembles Renga and The Band, its Foyle Future Firsts apprenticeship scheme for outstanding young instrumentalists, and regular family and schools concerts.

To help maintain its high standards and diverse workload, the Orchestra is committed to the welfare of its musicians and in December 2007 received the Association of British Orchestras/Musicians Benevolent Fund Healthy Orchestra Bronze Charter Mark.

There are many ways to experience and stay in touch with the Orchestra's activities: visit www.lpo.org.uk, subscribe to our podcast series and join us on Facebook.

WELCOME

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ALEXANDER VEDERNIKOV

CONDUCTOR



Alexander Vedernikov was Music Director and Chief Conductor of the Bolshoi Theatre from 2001 until 2009. He has been credited with rebuilding the Bolshoi Theatre's historical reputation for artistic excellence. He led many productions there, including a new production of *Boris Godunov* in the original Mussorgsky orchestration, Tchaikovsky's *Eugene Onegin*, Puccini's *Turandot*, Prokofiev's *Cinderella*, *War and Peace* and *The Fiery Angel*, the world première of Leonid Desyatnikov's *The Children of Rosenthal* commissioned by the Bolshoi Theatre, Wagner's *The Flying Dutchman*, Glinka's *Ruslan and Ludmila*, Mussorgsky's *Khovanshchina* and Cilea's *Adriana Lecouvreur*.

He was also responsible for developing the Bolshoi's programme of symphonic concerts, featuring a very broad repertoire, including Prokofiev's *Cinderella,* Berlioz's *La Damnation de Faust*, Verdi's *Requiem,* scenes from the operas of Wagner, and music by Richard Strauss, Alban Berg, Dmitri Shostakovich and Georgy Sviridov. Under his direction, the orchestra of the Bolshoi toured extensively, visiting Athens, Hamburg and Paris in February 2008 and giving a season of opera and ballet at the Royal Opera House, Covent Garden, in July 2006 which included *The Fiery Angel* and *Boris Godunov* where the orchestra in particular was singled out for its exceptional playing. Recent opera and symphonic performances at La Scala were equally successful.

Aside from his immense success in Russia, Alexander Vedernikov performs extensively throughout Europe and further afield. Recent seasons have included engagements with the London Philharmonic Orchestra, Bayerischer Rundfunk Symphony Orchestra (at Mariss Jansons' personal request), Maggio Musicale Florence and Orchestra della Svizzera Italiana with Martha Argerich at the Martha Argerich Project in Lugano, as well as with the Netherlands Philharmonic, Stockholm Philharmonic, Gothenburg Symphony and Hamburg Philharmonic Orchestras. He has also conducted the NHK Symphony, Staatskapelle Dresden, Montreal Symphony, Sydney Symphony, Tokyo Philharmonic, Royal Scottish National, BBC Scottish Symphony, RAI National, Danish National Symphony, Bergen Philharmonic and Budapest Symphony Orchestras.

In the field of opera, Alexander Vedernikov has appeared as guest conductor at La Scala Milan, La Fenice, Teatro Comunale Bologna, Teatro Reggio Turin and Rome Opera. In April 2005, he made his debut at the Bastille Opéra in Paris conducting a new production of *Boris Godunov* directed by Francesca Zambello.

Born in Moscow into a musical family – his father was a bass soloist at the Bolshoi and his mother a professor of organ at the Moscow Conservatoire – he studied at the Moscow Conservatoire and completed his postgraduate studies in 1990.

From 1988-90, he worked at Moscow's Stanislavsky and Nemirovich-Danchenko Music Theatre and from 1988-95, he was assistant to the chief conductor and second conductor of the Tchaikovsky Symphony Orchestra, which he accompanied on many tours in Russia, Austria, Germany, Greece, Turkey and Great Britain. In 1995, he founded the Russian Philharmonia Symphony Orchestra and was Artistic Director and Chief Conductor of this orchestra until 2004. He has conducted Russia's State Symphony Orchestra and the Academic Symphony Orchestra of the St Petersburg Philharmonic. Since 2003, he has been a member of the conductors' collegium of the Russian National Orchestra, with whom he has toured in France, Germany and the United States. In January 2004, as part of the Russian National Orchestra's tour of nine cities, Alexander Vedernikov made his debut at Carnegie Hall and the Kennedy Center, Washington.

In September 2009 he took up the role of Chief Conductor of the Odense Orchestra in Denmark.

PIERS LANE

PIANO



London-based Australian pianist Piers Lane has a flourishing international career which has taken him to more than 40 countries. In the past few years his engagements have included concerto performances at New York's Avery Fisher Hall and Lincoln Center; a three-recital series called *Metamorphoses* at London's Wigmore Hall and a recital for the opening of the Sydney International Piano Competition.

He has performed with many of the world's leading orchestras including the BBC orchestras; Australia's ABC orchestras; the Aarhus, American, Bournemouth and Gothenburg Symphony Orchestras; Kanazawa Ensemble, Orchestre National de France, City of London Sinfonia, Royal Philharmonic Orchestra and Royal Liverpool Philharmonic Orchestra among others. Leading conductors with whom he has worked in recent years include Andrey Boreyko, Sir Andrew Davis, Richard Hickox, Andrew Litton, Sir Charles Mackerras (for whose 70th birthday gala he played the Mozart/ Hummel Concerto K491 at the Barbican Centre), Jerzy Maksymiuk, Maxim Shostakovich, Vassily Sinaisky, Yan Pascal Tortelier and Antoni Wit. Piers Lane's festival appearances have taken him to Bard and Newport in the USA; Bergen, Elverum and Trondheim in Norway; Como Autumn Music in Italy; Prague Spring; The Ruhr Klavierfestival and Schloss vor Husum in Germany; La Roque d'Antheron and Paris Chopin in France; and Valdemossa Chopin in Mallorca.

Piers Lane's concerto repertoire exceeds 80 works. He has been a soloist at the BBC Proms in the Royal Albert Hall five times and, in 2007, his performance of Beethoven's *Emperor* Concerto with the Queensland Orchestra received the *Limelight Magazine* Award for Best Orchestral Performance.

In 2007, Piers Lane's chamber music expertise was recognised with his appointment as Artistic Director of the Australian Festival of Chamber Music. He is also Artistic Director of the Myra Hess Day held annually at the National Gallery in London.

Highlights of 2009 and 2010 include a recital for Wigmore Hall's London Pianoforte Series, a concerto performance in Glasgow with the BBC Scottish Symphony Orchestra, concerto performances with the Royal Philharmonic Orchestra and the Philharmonia, a date with the Tasmanian Symphony Orchestra during his annual tour of Australia and New Zealand, a ten-date concert tour of New Zealand with the Doric String Quartet, a return to the Banff Centre for the Arts in Canada, and a recording on the Hyperion label.

Piers Lane is also in great demand as a chamber music player and continues his long-standing partnership with British violinist Tasmin Little. Other recent collaborations have included Musica Viva tours with soprano Cheryl Barker, baritone Peter Coleman-Wright and violist/composer Brett Dean, and performances with Anne Sofie von Otter and Bengt Forsberg in Malmö, Stockholm and the Bergen Festival. He is also embarking on a new and exciting collaboration with clarinettist, Michael Collins, as well as developing his relationship with the Australian based Goldner String Quartet.

His extensive discography includes much admired recordings of rare Romantic Concertos, the complete Preludes and Etudes by Scriabin and transcriptions of Bach and Strauss, along with complete collections of Concert Etudes by Saint-Saëns, Moscheles and Henselt, and transcriptions by Grainger. Recent releases include the Piano Concerto by William Busch and the Piano Quintet by Bloch with Australia's Goldner String Quartet, an Editor's Choice in *Gramophone Magazine* and Record of the Month in *BBC Music Magazine* in 2008.

Piers Lane has written and presented over 100 programmes for BBC Radio 3, including the popular 54-part series *The Piano*.

Visit his website at www.pierslane.com for more information.

SPEEDREAD

This evening's Russian programme opens with Prokofiev's *Classical* Symphony, the first of his seven. A hit right from its birth, it was conceived in 1917 as a symphony along lines that Haydn might have followed if he had been living in the 20th-century. The four movements are not just pastiche, however, but constructed with a strikingly witty originality fully worthy of comparison with the 18th-century master.

Rachmaninoff enjoyed great success in London in 1898-99 and was invited to return and play his First Piano Concerto. Instead he decided to compose a second one. Completed in 1901, the new concerto displayed his gift for romantic expression at its most typical and attractive, and it has long been the most popular of his four. There are the usual three movements, but curiously the first was the last to be composed.

Tchaikovsky considered in his Fourth Symphony how life alternates 'between grim reality and fleeting dreams of happiness'. Fate intrudes upon waltz-time longings in the first of the four movements. Wistful memories occupy the second movement, which is followed by a novel three-part scherzo. The boisterous finale is based on a Russian folksong; 'rejoice in the joy of others and life is bearable after all'.

© Eric Mason

Sergei PROKOFIEV



1891-1953

CLASSICAL SYMPHONY, OP. 25

Allegro | *Larghetto* | *Gavotte: Non troppo allegro* | *Molto vivace*

Having been a child prodigy as pianist and composer, Prokofiev was a superbly equipped and already quite experienced musician when he graduated from the St Petersburg Conservatory in 1914. He had valuable champions in such elder contemporaries as Miaskovsky, Taneiev, Glière and Nikolai Tcherepnin, but the pungent, combative nature of most of his early compositions was not calculated to please many hearers. Even Diaghilev was taken aback when he commissioned a ballet on prehistoric themes from the young composer in 1914 and received the explosive *Ala and Lolly*. (Prokofiev turned it into the *Scythian Suite* for the concert hall.) It was therefore quite a surprise when the first of Prokofiev's seven symphonies proved to be genial, lyrical and instantly accessible. Composed in 1917, it received its first performance the following year in St Petersburg with the composer conducting.

Until this time Prokofiev had usually composed at the piano, but now he wanted to write a symphonic work without a piano to hand. He had acquired a taste for Haydn and Mozart and, feeling that he understood Haydn's technique, he decided that writing a symphony in D along lines that a 20th-century Haydn might have followed would be the safest way to compose without the aid of a keyboard. 'If Haydn had lived to our day,' he wrote later, 'he would have preserved his manner of writing and at the same time would have absorbed something of the new. That was the kind of symphony I wanted to write, and when it began to gel I renamed it *Classical Symphony,* first because it is simpler, second – just for fun – to tease the "geese" and in secret hope that eventually the symphony would become a classic.'

His hope was soon fulfilled. This symphony was his first work to win universal recognition, although it has not always been recognised that the 'new' elements make it a strikingly original work rather than clever pastiche. The form may be 18th-century classical, but the piquant harmonies, adroit melodic turns and rhythmic ingenuity

are typical of Prokofiev in his wittiest vein. The symphony is scored for double woodwind, horns, trumpets, timpani and strings.

The first movement in compressed sonata form presents its first subject on violins and flutes in turn and its wide-stepping second subject on violins with bassoon accompaniment. The working out of these ideas needs no explanation. The slow movement's theme begins very softly and high up, descends slowly and then climbs again. After a more animated central episode the initial theme returns with woodwind counterpoints. Instead of a minuet and trio for third movement Prokofiev provides a catchy gavotte. Its middle section is a musette with drone bass. The finale has three themes, and Prokofiev deploys them with a merry humour worthy of Haydn himself.

© *Eric Mason*



Sergei RACHMANINOFF

1873-1943

CONCERTO 2 IN C MINOR FOR PIANO AND ORCHESTRA, OP. 18

PIERS LANE *piano*

Allegro moderato | *Adagio sostenuto* | *Allegro scherzando*

Rachmaninoff's First Symphony, completed in 1895, was such a disastrous failure on its first appearance that he suffered a nervous breakdown and for some time was unable to face the prospect of composing at all. In the winter of 1898-99, however, he enjoyed such a success in London as conductor, pianist and composer that he was invited to return and play his First Piano Concerto. This, he felt, was too immature (he revised it in 1917) and he decided instead to write a new concerto. The second and third movements were finished the following year and performed in Moscow with Rachmaninoff as soloist, and the first movement was added in 1901. Although it is less cohesive than the Third Concerto, it shows the composer's gift of melodic invention at its most typical and attractive and has long been the most popular of his four piano concertos.

It is not evident from the music that the first movement was the last written, for the finale appears to derive features from it, notably from the swelling piano chords with which the concerto begins. These lead directly into the first subject, a long tune *con passione* on the upper strings against swirling arpeggios for the piano. It is characteristic of the composer that the melody repeatedly returns to and winds closely around the keynote. Consideration of this theme concludes with an orchestral *fortissimo*. A transitional passage for violas with an accompaniment for clarinets brings us to the second subject, a romantic melody introduced by the soloist. The development is mainly concerned with the first subject in association with a rhythmic motive first heard on the lower strings. The recapitulation begins with the first subject on the strings with piano accompaniment. A horn reintroduces the second subject, on which the piano freely rhapsodises. There is no piano cadenza, the movement proceeding directly to a coda.

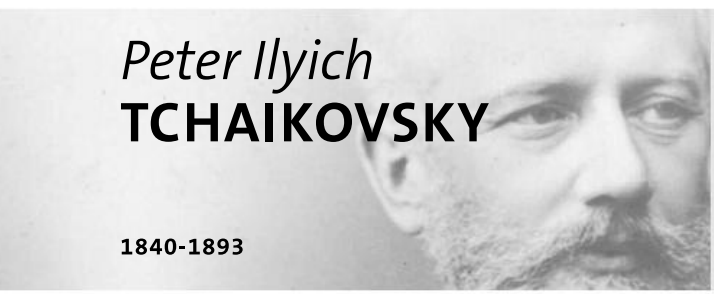
Four preludial bars exchange the first movement's C minor for E major, the key of the slow movement. The piano commences an accompanimental pattern on which is floated a melody of two strains entrusted respectively to flute and clarinet. Piano and orchestra discuss the two elements until a more vigorous passage for the piano leads to the relatively animated middle section, which culminates in a cadenza for the soloist. The end of the cadenza dissolves into the piano's original accompanimental pattern, and the principal theme is heard once more, this time on the strings. A poetic variant of this makes an exquisite coda.

Like the second movement the finale has a short introduction to establish mood and key, in this case returning from E major to the original C minor. A brilliant piano cadenza leads to a rhythmic version of the concerto's opening chords and to the finale's brisk first subject, to which subsidiary ideas are appended. A broader version of the theme on the piano heralds the celebrated second subject, which is introduced by violas and oboes and repeated by the piano. A triplet version of the first theme on the piano, accompanied by brushed cymbals, precedes the return and further variation of that theme, including a brief fugal treatment. The big second subject tune comes back in D flat and, after a repeat of the triplet passage and some orchestral play with fragments of the first theme, makes its majestic last appearance on piano and full orchestra in C major. The ending is brief, brisk and joyful.

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INTERVAL 20 minutes

An announcement will be made five minutes before the end of the interval.



Peter Ilyich TCHAIKOVSKY

1840-1893

SYMPHONY 4 IN F MINOR, OP. 36

Andante sostenuto - Moderato con anima | Andantino in modo di Canzona | Scherzo: Allegro | Finale: Allegro con fuoco

For two unconnected reasons 1877 was a fateful year in Tchaikovsky's life. First, it was the year in which his friendship with Nadezhda von Meck, the wealthy benefactress whom by mutual agreement he never intentionally met, ripened. Tchaikovsky wrote to her in May that he had been at work since the winter on a symphony, and by early June he was able to tell her that the four movements were complete except for orchestration. She accepted the dedication 'To my best friend' on condition that her name was not specified.

At this time Tchaikovsky became engrossed in composing his opera *Eugene Onegin*, and the Pushkin story was a powerful factor in persuading him into a loveless marriage that July to a young woman he hardly knew. Within two months he was brought to a nervous breakdown and attempted suicide, and not until December was he sufficiently recovered to tackle the orchestration of the symphony. He worked at this in Venice and completed the task in San Remo early in the New Year.

The first performance took place in Moscow on 22 February 1878 under Nicholas Rubinstein, but it was ill-prepared and made little impression. The St Petersburg première in November under Eduard Napravnik was a success, but the symphony did not become popular in Russia during the composer's lifetime. He himself, often a prey to self-doubt, thought the symphony the best he had so far composed. 'I believe', he said, 'that I have written music which cannot fall into oblivion.'

Thanks to his correspondence with Mrs von Meck we have a detailed account of the programme underlying

the Fourth Symphony. The sinister brass fanfare that opens and dominates the first movement represents Fate, Tchaikovsky wrote, 'the force that prevents us from ever attaining complete happiness ... It can never be overcome. One can only submit to it and take refuge in futile longings.' The main part of the movement, marked 'in waltz time', begins with such longings, expressed by a syncopated melody that becomes increasingly agitated and rises to a despairing climax. Clarinet and bassoon exchanges lead to the second subject on clarinet – 'Would it not be better to turn away from reality and plunge oneself in dreams?' Flutes and oboes take up this theme over a cello counter-melody which soon becomes a swaying major-key theme for the violins against soft drum-taps, answered by a major version of the syncopated melody on woodwind – 'Some luminous human form passes by and beckons. All that was dark and joyless is forgotten.' Happiness does not last; the agitation returns and the Fate motive reappears to open the development section, which is almost exclusively concerned with the first subject and the ever more insistent Fate. 'Thus the whole of life', wrote Tchaikovsky, 'is a continual alternation between grim reality and fleeting dreams of happiness.' The recapitulation recalls the themes in unorthodox D minor, and there is a long coda ending with the first subject.

The second movement, in B flat minor, expresses the 'melancholy which steals over us when, at evening, we sit indoors alone, weary of work ... A long procession of memories goes by. How sad to think how much is already past! And yet these recollections of youth are sweet.' A solo oboe plays a plaintive, folk-like tune with pizzicato string accompaniment. The cellos take it over and this brings an answering melody, after which both ideas are repeated in different scoring. The faster central episode in F major has another folk-like tune, introduced by clarinets and bassoons. When the original themes return, they are presented in still more varied dress and with charming ornaments.

Tchaikovsky had high hopes that the novel scherzo would please. It is in three sections, the first being for pizzicato strings and representing 'fleeting images that come into a man's head when he has been drinking'. The trio section is for woodwind (suggested by peasants on the spree and a street song) and brass (a distant military brand), after which the three sections of the orchestra join forces in a brilliantly conceived and executed recapitulation.

For the main theme of the finale Tchaikovsky borrowed a Russian folksong, *In the field there stood a birch tree*, which is introduced by the woodwind after two noisy introductory flourishes. A further statement of the flourishes announces the second theme, a jolly march-like tune for full orchestra. The intention is to suggest a rustic holiday with its attendant merrymaking. 'If you cannot find reason for happiness in yourself ... get out among the people. See what a good time they have.' There follow two groups of variations on the folksong, divided by the second theme. The last variation is interrupted by the sudden return of the Fate theme. This time, however, it does not dampen spirits for long, and the symphony ends in a merry mood. 'Simple, unspoiled happiness does exist. Rejoice in the joy of others and life is bearable after all.'

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15 November to
1 December 2009



BETWEEN TWO WORLDS

A festival exploring the life and work of Alfred Schnittke

London Philharmonic Orchestra

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BETWEEN TWO WORLDS

A festival exploring the life and work of Alfred Schnittke

Vladimir Jurowski
Festival Director / Conductor

Wednesday 18 November | 7.30pm | Southbank Centre's Royal Festival Hall
Haydn Symphony 22 (The Philosopher) **Wagner** Prelude and Good Friday Spell from *Parsifal* **Schnittke** Excerpts from *The History of D. Johann Faustus* (UK première)
Stephen Richardson *Dr Faustus* Anna Larsson *Mephistophila* Marco Lazzara *Mephistophiles* Markus Brutscher *Narrator* Moscow Conservatory Chamber Choir

Sunday 22 November | from 10am | Southbank Centre's Queen Elizabeth Hall and Purcell Room
In the labyrinth of Alfred Schnittke: a day of music and discussion
Allison Bell *soprano* Dmitry Sitkovetsky *violin* Alexander Zemtsov *viola* Alexander Ivashkin *cello* Boris Petrushansky *piano* Royal College of Music Chamber Orchestra Moscow Conservatory Chamber Choir

Wednesday 25 November | 7.30pm | Southbank Centre's Royal Festival Hall
Webern Passacaglia **Lindberg** Chorale **Berg** Violin Concerto **Schnittke** Symphony 3
Leonidas Kavakos *violin*

Saturday 28 November | 2.30pm | Southbank Centre's Royal Festival Hall
A screening of Elem Klimov's 1974 film *The Agony*, with score by Alfred Schnittke

Saturday 28 November | 7.30pm | Southbank Centre's Royal Festival Hall
Schnittke Cello Concerto 2 **Haydn** The Seven Last Words
Alexander Ivashkin *cello* Lisa Milne *soprano* Ruxandra Donose *mezzo soprano* Andrew Kennedy *tenor* Christopher Maltman *baritone* London Philharmonic Choir

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AT SOUTHBANK CENTRE'S ROYAL FESTIVAL HALL

Wednesday 4 November 2009 | 7.30pm

Wagner Overture, Tannhäuser
Wagner Wesendonk-Lieder
Bruckner Symphony 6

Christoph Eschenbach conductor
Petra Lang mezzo soprano




Christoph Eschenbach and Petra Lang

JTI Friday Series | Friday 6 November 2009 | 7.30pm

Verdi Overture, La forza del destino
Tchaikovsky Piano Concerto 1
Dvořák Symphony 9 (From the New World)

Yutaka Sado conductor
Denis Matsuev piano




Yutaka Sado and Denis Matsuev

BETWEEN TWO WORLDS – THE LIFE AND WORK OF ALFRED SCHNITTKE
Wednesday 18 November 2009 | 7.30pm

Haydn Symphony 22 (The Philosopher)
Wagner Prelude and Good Friday Spell from 'Parsifal'
Schnittke Excerpts from 'The History of D. Johann Faustus' (UK première)
Sung in German with English surtitles.

Vladimir Jurowski conductor
Cast includes:
Stephen Richardson Dr Faustus
Anna Larsson Mephistophila
Marco Lazzara Mephistophiles
Markus Brutscher Narrator
Moscow Conservatory Chamber Choir

6.15pm | Royal Festival Hall
FREE Pre-Concert Event
A performance of Schnittke's String Quartet No. 3 by the Harpham Quartet.

Sunday 22 November 2009 | Study Day
Queen Elizabeth Hall
IN THE LABYRINTH OF ALFRED SCHNITTKE
An absorbing day of music and discussion celebrating the life and music of Alfred Schnittke. Pick up a leaflet in the foyer for full details.




Vladimir Jurowski and Leonidas Kavakos

Wednesday 25 November 2009 | 7.30pm

Webern Passacaglia
Lindberg Chorale
Berg Violin Concerto
Schnittke Symphony 3

Vladimir Jurowski conductor
Leonidas Kavakos violin

6.00pm | Royal Festival Hall
FREE Pre-Concert Event
A performance of works including the Bach/Webern *Ricercar* and Schnittke's *Polyphonic Tango* by Foyle Future Firsts conducted by Vladimir Jurowski.

Bar*lines* | Central Bar, Level 2 Foyer
FREE Post-Concert Event
An informal discussion with Vladimir Jurowski and the evening's soloist, Leonidas Kavakos.

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